Meridian Group (fictional demo): current state across 3 countries

Arden · Belmar · Caldera · 11/13/2026

1 Where we stand

One line, then each country on the same scale.

THE VERDICT, IN ONE OR TWO SENTENCES

> **Three countries run one business on three operating models. One difference is required by regulation. The widest gaps are inherited from before the merger, and they cost speed and safety margin in cargo handling.**

Arden MERIDIAN

3.3 average level of 4

3 of 24 scored cells need action

≈ **$131m** at risk (estimate)

100% of cells scored · 100% cite a source

Belmar MERIDIANBE

2.8 average level of 4

6 of 24 scored cells need action

≈ **$101m** at risk (estimate)

100% of cells scored · 100% cite a source

Caldera MERIDIANCA

2.7 average level of 4

8 of 20 scored cells need action

≈ **$71.8m** at risk (estimate)

83% of cells scored · 83% cite a source

Across the countries: ≈ $304m at risk (estimate, same currency and unit). Money at risk is an estimate until finance validates the amount on each lever.

2 Where the countries differ

Same capabilities, same scale. Wide gaps are flagged.

CAPABILITY	ARDEN	BELMAR	CALDERA	GAP BETWEEN COUNTRIES
CAP-01 Gateway / Hub Services	3.3 (4 3 4 2) ↗ Improving	2.5 (3 3 2 2)	2.8 (4 2 2 3)	0.8
CAP-02 Food & Catering Solutions	3.5 (4 4 4 2) → Stable	3.5 (4 3 4 3)	3.0 (3 3 3 3)	0.5
CAP-03 Technology, Data & AI	3.3 (4 3 3 3) ↗ Improving	2.3 (2 2 2 3)	2.3 (3 2 2 2)	1.0 ⚑ wide
CAP-04 Commercial Leadership	3.0 (4 2 3 3) ↗ Improving	3.0 (3 3 3 3)	2.3 (2 2 2 3)	0.8
CAP-05 Enterprise Leadership	3.5 (4 4 3 3) → Stable	3.0 (3 3 3 3)	3.3 (4 3 3 3)	0.5
CAP-06 Human Capital & Enabling	3.3 (4 3 3 3) ↗ Improving	2.8 (3 2 3 3)	Not scored	0.5

The large number is the average level (1 Absent to 4 Established) across the lenses scored in that country. The four small squares are Structure, People, Process, Culture, in that order. “Not scored” means nobody has assessed it yet; it is never counted as weak.

19 cells scored differently	**3** material (two levels or more)	**1** Required	**1** Chosen	**2** Inherited	**15** still to classify

3 Who really decides

Where decisions are made in practice, against where the documents say they are made.

Arden

CONFIRMED **Renewal pricing is decided by the regional finance controller, not the commercial lead named in the policy 6 days (median delay)**

Types: Different role. Impact: adds about six working days to each renewal. Verdict: Risky drift.

X1

CONFIRMED **Renewals slip because pricing authority sits outside the commercial team**

Supported. Behind it: X1.

H1

Belmar

CONFIRMED **Load plans are signed off by the shift supervisor, not the certified load controller 3 of 10 turns observed**

Types: Different role, Skipped check. Impact: safety exposure on wide-body turns. Verdict: Risky drift.

X1

INDICATED **Overtime is approved by the station manager without the regional roster owner**

Types: Different role. Impact: roster decisions made twice. Verdict: Unexplained.

X3

Caldera

INDICATED **Commercial terms are approved by the operations director**

Types: Different role. Impact: price follows capacity, not customer value. Verdict: Unexplained.

X1

Source: Process Map Studio and Org Modeling findings that concern who decides, owns or approves. Strongest evidence first.

4 Which roles exist where, and why

The anchor roles the model depends on, country by country.

ROLE	KIND	ARDEN	BELMAR	CALDERA
RL-013 **Bid & Solutions Architect** Commercial Leadership	CRITICAL ROLE	○ Absent	◖ Thin bench	○ Absent
RL-002 **Cargo & Pharma Manager (cold-chain certified)** Gateway / Hub Services	DUAL-CRITICAL	● Exists	● Exists	◖ Thin bench
RL-011 **Head of Pricing / Revenue Management** Commercial Leadership	CRITICAL ROLE	○ Absent	● Exists	○ Absent
RL-007 **Head, Analytics & AI** Technology, Data & AI	CRITICAL ROLE	◖ Thin bench	○ Absent	◖ Thin bench
RL-008 **Head, Data Engineering & Platform** Technology, Data & AI	CRITICAL ROLE	◖ Thin bench	○ Absent	○ Absent

and 6 more roles that differ or are missing, on the Compare tab

⚑ 9 anchor roles are absent or thin somewhere: Bid & Solutions Architect (Arden, Belmar, Caldera); Cargo & Pharma Manager (cold-chain certified) (Caldera); Head of Pricing / Revenue Management (Arden, Caldera); and 6 more

Why the roles are there

Arden

CONFIRMED **Seven layers from the chief executive to the front line in Commercial** 7 layers

Design criterion: no more than five. Median span of control is four.

DC-1

INDICATED **Knowledge risk at Build the solution design**

Only two people can price a multi-station contract.

S-06

and 2 more in the findings register

Belmar

CONFIRMED **Belmar has no analytics team; reporting is bought as a service** 0 roles

A deliberate decision taken in 2025 on cost grounds.

DC-2

INDICATED **Reason this role is missing: the Hub Duty Controller is covered by rotating supervisors**

Nobody holds disruption judgement as their job.

RL-004

Caldera

CONFIRMED **Commercial reports into Operations, not to the group commercial lead**

Unchanged since the acquisition.

DC-1

5 How work really runs

Where practice departs from the documents, and what it costs.

Arden

INDICATED **Bid packs are rebuilt for each customer instead of reused 11 of 14 bids**

Types: Rework. Impact: slower bids, inconsistent terms. Verdict: Unexplained.

X2

INDICATED **Renewal offers reach the customer 90 days before expiry 90 days**

Not met.

I1

HYPOTHESIS **VP Global Account Management: capacity freed (estimate) 0.3 FTE**

Reporting tasks reduced; not yet validated with the role holder.

RL-014

Belmar

INDICATED **Two load-planning systems have run in parallel since the merger 2 systems**

Types: Duplicate work. Impact: double entry on every departure. Verdict: Obsolete rule.

X2

Caldera

CONFIRMED **A nationally certified load controller must sign every turn Every turn**

Types: Extra step. Impact: the bench cannot be shared across borders. Verdict: Effective adaptation.

X2

Each line keeps the ID and grade it was given in the app that found it. Confirmed means verified at source; Indicated means supported but not verified; Hypothesis means still to test.

6 What we ask you to decide

Every difference lands in one of three places.

Harmonise

Inherited: History, an acquisition or habit. Nobody decided it.

CAP-04.Structure **Commercial Leadership** · Structure
Arden L4 · Caldera L2 — Caldera's commercial team reports to operations, unchanged since the acquisition.

CAP-01.Process **Gateway / Hub Services** · Process
Arden L4 · Belmar, Caldera L2 — Belmar and Caldera still run the pre-merger load-planning process.

Decide: keep or align

Chosen: A deliberate local decision, made for a reason someone can state.

CAP-03.Structure **Technology, Data & AI** · Structure
Arden L4 · Belmar L2 — Belmar buys analytics as a service rather than staffing a team.

Leave local

Required: Regulation, a customer contract or the physical site makes it so.

CAP-01.People **Gateway / Hub Services** · People
Arden, Belmar L3 · Caldera L2 — Caldera's regulator requires nationally certified load controllers.

15 smaller differences (one level apart) are not classed and not part of this ask.

Where we would pilot the design

Arden: VS-01 Bid to contract renewal (Win rate on renewals; days from bid request to signed contract); VS-02 Roster to shift cover (Overtime and agency hours per 1,000 handled units)

THE ASK

> **Agree to harmonise the two inherited differences, starting with load planning in Belmar. Confirm that analytics stays a local choice in Belmar for one more cycle. Approve the renewal pilot in Arden.**